

Ideation Phase

Define Problem Statement

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1. Background

The project addresses the need to bring structured employee data from an external spreadsheet into ServiceNow in a controlled and repeatable way.

2. Current Challenge

- Spreadsheet records must be loaded into ServiceNow without manually recreating each record.
- Source columns need to be mapped to the correct target fields.
- Repeated imports must be handled without unnecessary duplicate employee records.
- Users need simple views of employee distribution and records after import.

3. Problem Statement

How can structured employee data received in spreadsheet format be imported into ServiceNow accurately, transformed into a target employee table, updated safely when matching records already exist, and presented through useful reports and a dashboard?

4. Objectives

- Create an Employee Test custom table with the required employee fields.
- Create an Employee Import staging table from spreadsheet data.
- Configure the Sample Spreadsheet Import Transform Map.
- Map source fields to target fields and execute transformations.
- Use Coalesce to support update-versus-insert behavior.
- Create department, location, and employee-list reports.
- Combine the reports in Employee Analytics Dashboards.

5. Scope

In Scope	Out of Scope / Not Specified
Spreadsheet preparation and loading	External APIs
Import Set staging	Custom application code
Transform Map configuration	Production deployment procedures
Field mapping and transformation	Formal performance benchmarks
Coalesce-based matching	Formal sign-off records
Reports and dashboard	Additional integrations not described in the guide

6. Detailed Problem Analysis

The source spreadsheet is an external representation of employee information, while ServiceNow requires records to exist in a target table before they can be used consistently for reporting. A controlled import workflow is therefore required. Without a staging step, mapping step, and validation step, the movement of data would be harder to inspect and repeat.

7. Causes and Effects

The main causes addressed by the project are external spreadsheet-based data preparation, the need for structured ServiceNow records, and the possibility of repeated imports. These create several effects: manual record creation can be inefficient, inconsistent field mapping can affect data quality, and repeated imports can create unnecessary records unless matching behavior is configured.

8. Problem Boundaries

The project specifically addresses employee data represented by the fields Employee ID, Employee Name, Email, Department, and Location. It demonstrates the ServiceNow import and reporting workflow described in the guide. It does not claim to solve unrelated enterprise integration, production deployment, or broader identity-management requirements.

9. Success Definition

Success is demonstrated when the spreadsheet can be loaded into Employee Import, the Sample Spreadsheet Import Transform Map can map and transform the data into Employee Test, records can be checked after transformation, Coalesce can distinguish matching from new data during a repeat import, and the resulting records can be visualized through the three documented reports and dashboard.